

CHAPTER 7

GIVE YOUR KIDS AN MBA: MONEY & BANKING AWARENESS

My daughter, Savannah, was five years old when she asked me The Question. Linda and I had just taken her out to a neighborhood pizzeria to celebrate her last day of kindergarten. The server dropped off the check, and I immediately fished out my wallet to pay for the meal. I always made a point to carry cash when my kids were growing up—I wanted them to see it come out of my wallet rather than the magical plastic credit card.

Savannah watched as I thumbed through a couple of twenties and handed them to the server. “Daddy,” she said. “I always see you taking money out. But where does it come from?”

The Question. I knew she’d ask it one day, and that day had finally arrived.

“Where do you think money comes from, Savannah?” I asked.

She asked to see my wallet, so I handed it to her.

“It doesn’t come from your wallet,” she said.

“Smart girl,” I said.

“Sometimes I see Mommy put her card into the bank machine,” Savannah said. “When she pushes the buttons, money comes out.”